1. Purpose

This policy establishes rigorous standards, operational guidelines, and compliance protocols for all storage and warehousing facilities operated by Imperial Kitchen Group Inc. The primary purpose is to ensure the absolute safety, integrity, and quality of all food ingredients, packaging materials, and other materials throughout the warehousing lifecycle, preventing contamination, spoilage, pest infestation, and regulatory non-compliance in accordance with the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611) and the Code on Sanitation of the Philippines (PD No. 856).

2. Scope

This policy applies to all warehouse facilities, cold storage units, dry goods storage areas, staging zones, loading areas, and inventory handling personnel—including permanent employees, contractors, third-party logistics (3PL) providers, and management employees within Imperial Kitchen Group Inc.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall conduct routine and unannounced warehousing audits as well as comprehensive compliance checks by strictly utilizing standardized audit checklists to ensure absolute operational integrity. Furthermore, shall rigorously monitor pest control measures, review detailed sanitation logs, and evaluate temperature excursion reports to maintain optimal environmental and hygienic conditions across all storage and warehousing facilities. In addition, shall issue formal Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) plans for any identified non-conformances, operational deviations, or system failures, while simultaneously overseeing comprehensive retraining schedules to prevent recurrence, rectify procedural gaps, and uphold the highest standards of quality assurance.

3.2. Supply Chain Management (SCM)

Shall oversee the comprehensive operational flow and logistical frameworks governing all warehouse facilities, cold storage units, dry goods storage areas, staging zones, and loading areas within Imperial Kitchen Group Inc. Supply Chain Management shall ensure that inventory handling processes, logistics networks, and third-party interactions seamlessly integrate with the good warehousing practices policy to maintain product integrity and prevent any vulnerabilities or bottlenecks throughout the warehousing lifecycle, fully aligning with national food safety and sanitation mandates.

3.3. Warehouse Supervisor

Shall direct, supervise, and coordinate the day-to-day on-site activities of all inventory receiving and warehouse permanent and contractors employees, and third-party logistics (3PL) providers across every warehouse facility, cold storage unit, dry goods storage area, staging zone, and loading area. The warehouse supervisor shall enforce rigorous operational guidelines and compliance protocols to safeguard the quality, safety, and integrity of food ingredients, packaging materials, and finished products, thereby preventing contamination, spoilage, and pest infestation in strict compliance with the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611) and the Code on Sanitation of the Philippines (PD No. 856).

3.4. Warehouse Employees

Shall execute the fundamental, hands-on operational duties required within all warehouse facilities, cold storage units, dry goods storage areas, staging zones, and loading areas under the purview of Imperial Kitchen Group Inc. Warehouse employees shall handle food ingredients, packaging materials, and finished products with extreme care throughout the warehousing lifecycle, actively performing daily tasks designed to prevent contamination, spoilage, pest infestation, and

any departure from the rigorous standards set forth by the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611) and the Code on Sanitation of the Philippines (PD No. 856).

3.5. Receiving and/or Quality Control (QC)

Shall inspect all incoming shipments, verify physical quantities and documentation against purchase orders, meticulously check goods for any signs of damage, defects, or non-conformance, and ensure that all received items meet established quality standards and specifications before acceptance and transfer into the warehouse inventory.

3.6. Learning and Development Manager (L&D)

Shall design, develop, and implement comprehensive training programs and educational initiatives tailored for all inventory handling personnel, including permanent employees, contractors, third-party logistics (3PL) providers, and management employees within Imperial Kitchen Group Inc.. They shall ensure that all employees comprehensively understand the rigorous standards, operational guidelines, and compliance protocols required to maintain the absolute safety, integrity, and quality of food ingredients, packaging materials, and finished products in accordance with the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611) and the Code on Sanitation of the Philippines (PD No. 856).

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4. Facility and Environment Management

The physical infrastructure and internal climate must be proactively managed to shield inventory from external contamination and environmental degradation**.**

4.1. Premises Security

- Access to the facility must be strictly restricted to authorized personnel, contractors, and approved visitors.
- All entry points, loading docks, and perimeter gates must be monitored via access control systems and visitor logs to prevent unauthorized access or tampering.

4.2. Pest Control

- An active Integrated Pest Management (IPM) program must be maintained, utilizing professional monitoring, tamper-resistant bait stations, and physical exclusion methods (e.g., air curtains, tightly sealed doors).
- The perimeter and interior must be kept free of debris, standing water, and vegetation that could harbor pests.

4.3. Sanitation

- Comprehensive cleaning schedules and Sanitation Standard Operating Procedures (SSOPs) must be executed for all storage areas, floors, and receiving areas.
- Only approved, food-safe or facility-safe cleaning chemicals must be utilized, stored securely away from inventory, and properly labeled.

4.4. Environmental Controls

- Temperature and relative humidity levels must be continuously monitored and recorded, particularly for climate-sensitive and perishable goods, to prevent spoilage or mold growth.
- HVAC and ventilation systems must undergo regular servicing to ensure consistent airflow and climate stability.

4.5. Lighting and Infrastructure

- Lighting fixtures throughout storage and inspection areas must feature protective shatterproofing to prevent glass contamination.
- Floors, walls, and ceilings must be maintained in good repair—free of cracks, flaking paint, or leaks that could compromise product safety.

5. Personnel Safety and Hygiene

Employees are vital to operational success, but must operate under strict protocols to prevent personal injury and eliminate biological, chemical, or physical risks to inventory.

5.1. Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

- Mandatory PPE (such as high-visibility vests, safety shoes, and gloves where applicable) must be worn correctly within designated operational areas.
- PPE must be inspected regularly, maintained in clean condition, and replaced immediately when worn or damaged.

5.2. Health and Hygiene

- Strict personal hygiene standards apply; employees must wash and sanitize hands frequently, especially before handling open or sensitive stock.
- Personnel suffering from communicable illnesses or open, unbandaged wounds must be reassigned away from direct food handling.
- Eating, drinking, chewing gum, and smoking are strictly prohibited outside of designated break areas.

5.3. Ergonomics and Safe Lifting

- All employees handling manual loads must undergo training on safe lifting techniques to minimize musculoskeletal strain and workplace injuries.
- Mechanical lifting aids and team-lifting protocols must be utilized for heavy or awkward loads.

5.4. Emergency Procedures

- Clear, unobstructed evacuation routes and emergency exits must be maintained and marked with illuminated signage.
- First aid stations, eye-wash stations, and fire-fighting equipment must be inspected monthly, with regular evacuation drills conducted to ensure staff readiness.

6. Storage and Inventory Management

Systematic organization, accurate movement, and disciplined rotation of goods are essential to minimize waste, prevent damage, and eliminate cross-contamination.

6.1. Stock Rotation

- The First-In, First-Out (FIFO) and First-Expired, First-Out (FEFO) principles must be strictly enforced for all inventory movements to prevent aging and expiration loss.
- Stock placement must prioritize visibility of production dates and batch codes.

6.2. Segregation of Goods

- Physical barriers or designated separation zones must be used to isolate allergens, raw materials from finished goods, and chemicals from food products to prevent cross-contamination.
- Damaged, returned, or expired stock must be immediately moved to designated hold areas.

6.3. Aisles and Floor Markings

- All walkways, forklift lanes, and staging areas must be clearly delineated using durable floor striping.
- Aisles must remain completely unobstructed at all times to ensure safe transit and unblocked access to fire safety equipment.

6.4. Pallet Building and Stacking

- Pallets must be stacked in stable, interlocking configurations without product overhang, adhering strictly to maximum weight limits and height restrictions.

- Stretch-wrapping and strapping must be applied securely to maintain load integrity during transport and storage.

7. Equipment Operations and Maintenance

Warehouse machinery and infrastructure must function reliably and safely to protect inventory from physical damage and maintain a safe working environment.

7.1. Material Handling Equipment (MHE)

- Forklifts and pallet jacks must be operated exclusively by certified, authorized personnel.
- Operators must conduct pre-operational safety checklists daily (checking brakes, horns, steering, and hydraulics) before putting any machine into service.

7.2. Calibration of Measuring Device

- Scales, thermometers, and other measurement tools used in quality verification must be calibrated at scheduled intervals against certified standards.
- Calibration certificates and logs must be maintained on file for audit verification.

7.3. Preventive Maintenance (PM)

- All infrastructure and mechanical assets must follow a structured preventive maintenance schedule to preempt unexpected breakdowns.
- Any equipment malfunction must be reported immediately, tagged out of service, and repaired by qualified technicians before re-entry.

8. Documentation and Quality Assurance

Robust administrative controls provide verifiable proof of regulatory compliance, operational transparency, and adherence to established quality standards.

8.1. Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)

- Documented, step-by-step instructions for all warehouse processes must be readily accessible to employees at their workstations.
- SOPs must undergo periodic review by management to ensure they reflect current operational realities and regulatory requirements.

8.2. Traceability and Recordkeeping

- End-to-end traceability must be maintained by accurately recording lot numbers, batch codes, quantities, and timestamps for all inbound receipts, internal transfers, and outbound shipments.
- All logs whether digital or physical must be legible, securely archived, and easily retrievable during regulatory audits.

8.3. Product Recalls and Returns

- A documented recall and return procedure must be established to enable the swift identification, isolation, and retrieval of affected inventory within the supply chain.
- Mock recall exercises must be conducted periodically to test the speed and effectiveness of the trace-back system.

8.4. Quarantine Procedures

- Non-conforming, damaged, or suspect stock must be immediately placed under physical and system-level quarantine within a designated "Hold" area.
- Quarantined goods must be clearly tagged and cannot be moved, released, or disposed of without formal authorization from the Quality Assurance department.

9. Corrective Action

Instruction: The Corrective Action Plan will be coordinated with the appropriate department, while QA will verify the issued CAPA.

Level of Severity	Nature of Non - Conformance	Disciplinary Action
Minor	Internal process failures that may not directly impact product safety but affect overall efficiency and reputation *(e.g. An employee delaying the daily housekeeping or failing to ensure warehouse aisles are completely clear of minor clutter, affecting workflow efficiency without directly exposing food products to contamination.)*	**1st Offense:** Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and establishing an official timeline re-training for improvement. **2nd Offense:** A formal corrective action plan is issued by Quality Assurance (QA) **3rd Offense:** Final Warning letter will be given to the employee for continued non-compliance or Suspension without pay (1-2 days) when the employee did not comply after the final warning letter and to QA corrective action.
Major	Deviation from internal or contractual quality standards *(e.g. Failing to enforce the First-In, First-Out (FIFO) or First-Expired, First-Out (FEFO) stock rotation principles, or building unstable, non-interlocking pallet stacks that violate internal stacking guidelines.)*	**1st Offense:** Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and establishing an official timeline re-training for improvement. **2nd Offense:** A formal corrective action plan is issued by Quality Assurance (QA) **3rd Offense:** Final Warning letter will be given to the employee for continued non-compliance or Suspension without pay (2-3 days) when the employee did not comply after the final warning letter and to QA corrective action.

Critical	Failing to meet regulatory requirements, such as those outlined by the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611), and Code on Sanitation (PD No. 856) *(e.g. Breaching environmental controls by failing to maintain required temperature and relative humidity levels for perishable cold storage goods, or allowing active pest infestations in violation of national sanitation mandates.)*	**1st Offense:** Immediate Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and formal corrective action plan is issued by Quality Assurance (QA). **2nd Offense:** Final Warning, Suspension without pay (3-7 days) or leading directly to Termination

10. Training and Competency Verification

All warehouse employees must undergo mandatory induction training on Good Warehousing Practices, Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP), HACCP principles, and sanitation standards upon hiring, followed by annual refresher training. Training effectiveness is verified through written assessments, practical competency evaluations, and daily operational supervision by QA and Warehouse Supervisors. Records of all training sessions and signed attendance sheets shall be maintained by Human Resources and L&D.

11. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	July 24, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	Originator

	Name	Position	Signature with Date
Prepared by	Celine Joy Sanchez	Quality Assurance Specialist	
Reviewed by	Jackquelyn Aquino	Supply Chain Manager	
	Anthony Co	Human Resources Manager	
	Eric Co	Vice President	
Approved by	Jack Julius Tiu	President	

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